Data Quality Plan

Alyssa Federle

Data Validation: Quality and Cleaning

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Purpose Statement

During this merger it is vital to our business that we ensure that the integrated data maintains quality and integrity. High-quality data will allow our business to perform more accurate analyses that will lead to improved decision-making at the management level and help to ensure that daily operations are as efficient as possible. Since we are basing future decisions on the data obtained from the new firm it is important for us to spend resources to study the data quality. If the data is not at the level we expect, it could jeopardize the merger. We must make sure that any potential liabilities are eliminated. If the data proves to be high-quality it can generate value and reduce costs for our organization by improving our ability to make informed decisions. We would be able to do things like accurately staffing and budgeting to promote operational efficiency or maximize gain from new opportunities while avoiding potential risky transactions.

Organizational Goals

Three objectives of the organization with respect to high-quality data are accurate data analysis, operational efficiency, and regulatory compliance. Businesses desire accurate data analysis because it can improve their decision making, high-quality data provides the most accurate information for its users so they can reduce potential risks and better see and grasp profitable opportunities. When data is high-quality, businesses can operate more efficiently by reducing waste and improving productivity. High-quality data can also help businesses stay compliant to regulations by protecting customer information so they can avoid legalities, fines, and loss of trust.

Data Quality Characteristics and Procedures

Some characteristics that define data quality using industry standards are accuracy, reliability, and uniqueness. It is very important for data to be accurate in this acquisition. This data describes real world data we will be utilizing in order to make decisions. If the data is inaccurate, it could affect customers by incorrectly charging, delivering to wrong addresses, or sending sensitive information to the incorrect user. We can address accuracy by conducting regular audits. The new data should also be reliable, user access should be consistent and match the data from our old system. If there are issues with consistency it can affect integration and decision making since the conflicting data points can lead to different interpretations. We can address this dimension by making sure we smoothly integrate the new data into our system and centralizing management. The data entered from this acquisition should also be unique. Replicated data will not only slow down processing speeds but can also lead to inaccuracies which we want to avoid at all costs. We can address duplicate data by implementing algorithms that identify duplicate records and setting unique codes as identifiers.

Security and Personnel Responsibility

In order to ensure data quality, we should also look into adjusting our security policies. Should our security be lacking we run the risk of unauthorized access occurring and the data we rely on could be altered or deleted. As we are managing sensitive data, we a responsible in protecting the confidentiality of the company and our customers. Data risk management is important in this acquisition so we can protect ourselves from legal difficulties and keep the reputation and trust we have built with our clients and future clients. Some critical gaps that leadership should track to mitigate data risk are proper access controls, regulatory compliance, IT security employee training, seamless integration and centralization of the data, and data encryption for transfers and storage. For our organization to understand proper data governance

we should build roles like data stewards, data governance committees, and data custodians. These roles ensure things like daily management or data analysis (steward), policy approval or organizational accountability (committee), and infrastructure maintenance or security (custodian).

References

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